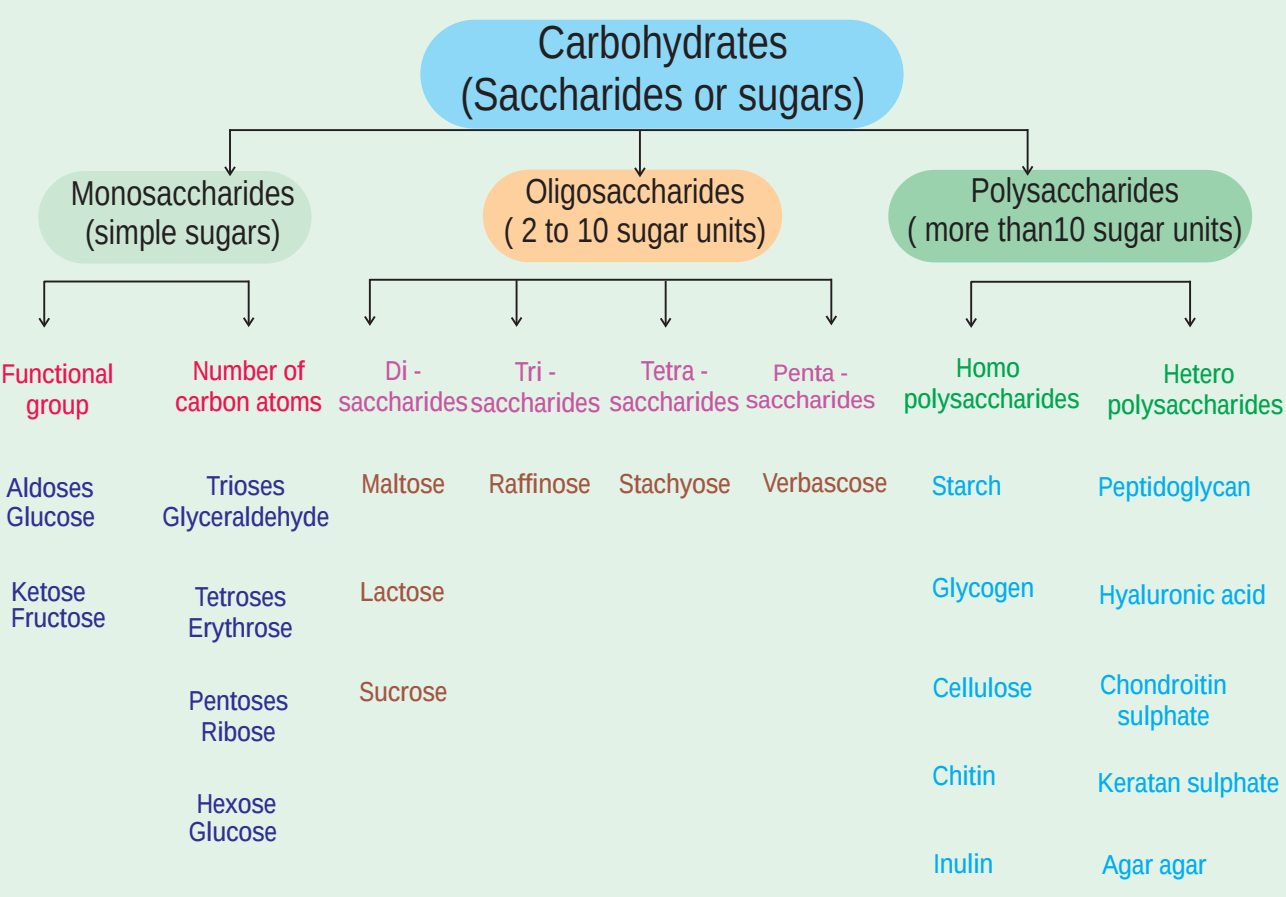


8.3.1 Monosaccharides – The Simple Sugars

Monosaccharides are relatively small molecules constituting single sugar unit. Glucose has a chemical formula of $C_6H_{12}O_6$. It is a six carbon molecule and hence is called as **hexose** (Figure 8.6).

All monosaccharides contain one of two functional groups. Some are aldehydes, like glucose and are referred as **aldoses**; other are ketones, like fructose and are referred as **ketoses**.



Glucose is one of the most well-known molecules due to its nature as an essential nutrient for human health. You ingest glucose in your food, and then your body uses blood to carry the glucose to the cells of every organ for the purpose of energy production.

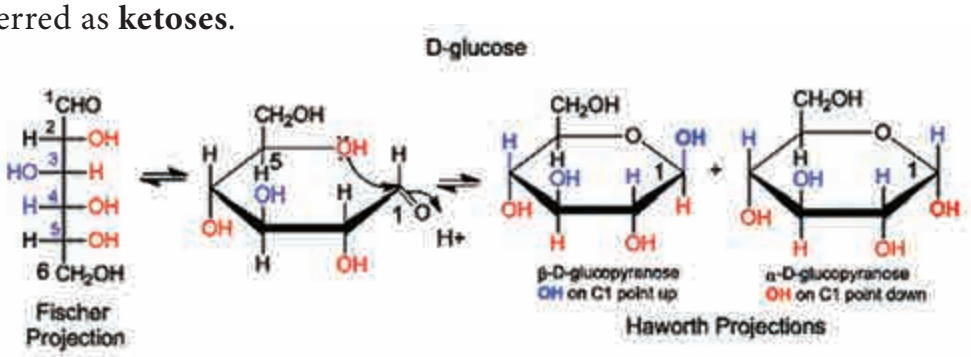


Figure 8.6: Structure of Glucose